GROUP 15

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PRACTICAL SKILL: MOBILE APP DEVELOPMENT

Smart Study Buddy

A Collaborative Mobile Platform for Student Learning Resources

Project Abstract.
University and college students routinely struggle to find reliable, organised, and course-specific academic resources. Lecture notes, past examination papers, and revision material are scattered across personal devices, social media chats, and informal peer networks, making them difficult to locate, verify, and share efficiently. At the same time, students who want to revise collaboratively often have no easy way of discovering or joining study groups relevant to the specific courses they are taking. Smart Study Buddy is a proposed mobile application designed to solve this problem by creating a single, centralised platform where students can upload, discover, and share academic resources, while also connecting with peers in subject-specific discussion and study groups.

Problem Statement.
Currently, there is no unified, student-owned platform tailored to the specific needs of course-based resource sharing and group study coordination. Existing solutions such as general cloud storage, social media groups, or messaging apps were not built for this purpose: they lack structured organisation by course or unit, offer no reliable way to verify the credibility or relevance of shared material, and make it difficult to discover or join study groups for a particular subject. This results in duplicated effort, missed opportunities for collaboration, and inconsistent access to quality academic resources, particularly for students preparing for examinations.

Proposed Solution.
Smart Study Buddy will be developed as a mobile application that brings together resource sharing, academic information, and peer collaboration in one place. The core features to be implemented include:

- Notes and past paper sharing: Students can upload, browse, search, and download notes and past examination papers organised by course, unit, and academic level.
- Academic information hub: A repository of course outlines, academic calendars, and general study-related announcements relevant to students.
- Discussion group discovery: The system will be able to compare student's profiles and match each student with their suitable discussion groups.
- In-app group interaction: Group members can post messages, ask questions, and coordinate study sessions within their joined groups.
- Search and filtering: Resources and groups can be filtered by course, unit, year, or topic for fast and relevant discovery.
- User profiles and contribution tracking: Each student has a profile showing the resources they have shared and the groups they belong to, encouraging active participation.
- Ratings and verification: Shared notes and papers can be rated or flagged by other users to help maintain content quality and credibility.
- Notifications: Students receive alerts on new uploads, group activity, or responses relevant to their courses.

Objectives.

- To design and develop a mobile application that enables students to upload, organise, and access notes and past papers by course.
- To implement a discovery system that allows students to locate and join course-specific discussion and study groups.
- To provide students with centralised access to relevant academic information in one platform.
- To encourage collaborative learning by enabling peer-to-peer interaction within study groups.
- To evaluate the usability and effectiveness of the application through testing with a sample group of students.

Significance of the Project.
Smart Study Buddy addresses a genuine, everyday challenge faced by students and demonstrates practical application of mobile app development skills, including user authentication, file handling, database design, real-time interaction, and user-centred interface design. Beyond its academic purpose as a course project, the platform has real-world potential to improve collaborative learning culture, reduce the time students spend searching for resources, and strengthen peer support networks within and across institutions.

Methodology and Tools.

The project will be developed using an agile, iterative approach, progressing through requirements gathering, UI/UX design, incremental development, and continuous testing. The application will be built for mobile devices using a modern cross-platform or native development framework, supported by a cloud-based backend and database for storing user data, uploaded resources, and group information. The team will conduct usability testing with peer students to refine the application before final submission.

Expected Outcome.

A fully functional mobile application prototype that allows students to register and create profiles, upload and access notes and past papers organised by course, discover and join discussion groups, and interact with peers, all within a single, intuitive platform.